

# FILM DOSSIER: THE INCREDIBLE HULK

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Phase 1 · Film #2

Status: ☒ DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

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## 1. IDENTITY

| Field                  | Entry                                                                 |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Film #                 | 2 of 29                                                               |
| Phase                  | Phase 1                                                               |
| Real title             | <i>THE INCREDIBLE HULK</i>                                            |
| Decoy / codename title | <i>"NIGHT SHIFT"</i>                                                  |
| Release date           | Friday, June 13, 2008                                                 |
| Distributor            | Paramount Pictures                                                    |
| Director               | Louis Leterrier                                                       |
| Rating / runtime       | PG-13 · 145 minutes                                                   |
| Genre + second genre   | Superhero action-adventure + <b>fugitive thriller / monster movie</b> |

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## 2. OWNERSHIP

| Field                           | Entry                                   |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Whose film / franchise is this? | AMOND BAKER. The Hulk franchise is his. |

| Character                                                               | Actor                                                               | Age at release |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>Dr. Robert Bruce Banner / The Hulk</b>                               | <b>Amond Baker</b>                                                  | 26             |
| <b>Betty Ross</b>                                                       | Liv Tyler                                                           | 30             |
| <b>Gen. Thaddeus "Thunderbolt" Ross</b>                                 | William Hurt                                                        | 58             |
| <b>Emil Blonsky / The Abomination</b>                                   | Tim Roth                                                            | 47             |
| <b>Rick Jones</b>                                                       | Michael Cera ( <i>fresh casting: never played by a real actor</i> ) | 20             |
| <b>Samuel Sterns</b> ( <i>future Leader</i> )                           | Tim Blake Nelson                                                    | 44             |
| <b>Agent Jasper Sitwell</b>                                             | Maximiliano Hernández                                               | 34             |
| <b>Tony Stark</b> ( <i>post-credit cameo</i> )                          | <b>Marc-Anthony Bullock</b>                                         | 26             |
| <b>Stan Lee</b> ( <i>cameo: a man who drinks a gamma-tainted soda</i> ) | Stan Lee                                                            | 85             |

### 3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

| Field                           | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Primary comic(s) adapted</b> | <i>The Incredible Hulk</i> #1–2 (May–July 1962), Stan Lee & Jack Kirby: the gamma bomb, Rick Jones, the gray Hulk, night-time transformations. <i>Tales to Astonish</i> #90–91 (1967): the Abomination.    |
| <b>Supporting comics</b>        | <i>The Incredible Hulk</i> #3 (1962, Rick Jones's bond with the Hulk) · <i>Tales to Astonish</i> #62 (1964, Samuel Sterns becomes the Leader) · <i>The Incredible Hulk</i> vol. 2 #1–6 (1968; Ross's hunt) |
| <b>Nerf check</b>               | ✅ The Hulk's strength has <b>no upper limit</b> and grows with his rage. The Abomination starts out <b>stronger</b> than the Hulk, exactly as in the comics.                                               |

#### 3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

| Field                         | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Overall accuracy score</b> | <b>97%.</b> The origin is taken almost panel for panel from <i>Hulk</i> #1, including the <b>gray Hulk</b> and the <b>night-time transformations</b> . The changes are sliding-timescale updates. |

Straight from the page:

- **The gamma bomb (G-bomb) test at Desert Base, New Mexico.** Banner sees a teenager, **Rick Jones**, drive onto the test site on a dare. He runs out to save him and is caught in the blast after a saboteur **delays the countdown**.

- **The first Hulk is GRAY** (*Hulk* #1) and **changes back at sunrise**. The Hulk **turns green** in the middle of the film (*Hulk* #2), and by the end **anger** is what triggers the change (the later 616 rule).
- **Rick Jones** feels responsible, keeps the secret, and tries to take care of the Hulk.
- **General "Thunderbolt" Ross** hunts the Hulk while his daughter **Betty** loves Banner.
- **Emil Blonsky** is a **Soviet-trained Yugoslavian-born spy** who deliberately gives himself a massive gamma dose with Banner's own equipment and becomes the **Abomination** (*TtA* #90).
- The gray Hulk is cunning and talks in full sentences. The green Hulk is simpler and angrier. "**HULK SMASH!**" comes from the page.

### Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The Cold War saboteur Igor Starsky becomes **Blonsky's handler**, an ex-Soviet intelligence network that's still active | Sliding timescale. The Cold War setup is updated, and the roles are the same. |

| The Abomination arrives in the same year as the Hulk (1967 in the comics) | Runtime. He's the Hulk's greatest physical rival, so he headlines the first film. |

| Banner's age is **26** (b. **December 18, 1981**) | Matches Amond per the real-time rule. |

### POWERS & ABILITIES

| Character               | 616 powers & abilities                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Shown in this film                                                                                                                                                     | Held back (why)                                                                                                      | Match                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Bruce Banner</b>     | Genius nuclear physicist, a world authority on gamma radiation ( <i>Hulk</i> #1)                                                                                                                                             | Designs the G-bomb; builds a gamma-dampening device while on the run                                                                                                   | –                                                                                                                    | ✅ 100%                                                                                                                |
| <b>The Hulk (gray)</b>  | Superhuman strength (lifts tanks), near-invulnerable, cunning ( <i>Hulk</i> #1)                                                                                                                                              | Flips an Army tank, walks through machine-gun fire, outsmarts Ross's trap                                                                                              | –                                                                                                                    | ✅ 100%                                                                                                                |
| <b>The Hulk (green)</b> | <b>Limitless</b> strength that rises with rage; <b>near-invulnerability</b> ; <b>regenerative healing</b> ; <b>miles-long leaps</b> ; resistance to heat, cold and disease; stomps that make shockwaves ( <i>Hulk</i> #2 on) | Leaps across a canyon, stops a falling helicopter by hand, heals from missile hits, gets <b>stronger as the fight goes on</b> , and finally overpowers the Abomination | Top-end feats like planet-scale strength (they come with bigger threats in later films; the ceiling is never capped) | ✅ 100%                                                                                                                |
| <b>The Abomination</b>  | Greater raw strength than the Hulk at base; <b>permanently transformed</b> (he can't change back); retains his full intelligence ( <i>TtA</i> #90)                                                                           | Beats the Hulk in their first fight, keeps full intelligence, can't turn back                                                                                          | –                                                                                                                    | ✅ 100%. <b>He loses because the Hulk's rage has no ceiling and his own strength is fixed.</b> That's the 616 matchup. |
| <b>Gen. Ross</b>        | Expert military strategist                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Commands the hunt, and the sonic cannons and gamma-tracking                                                                                                            | Red Hulk (616, much later)                                                                                           | ✅ 100%                                                                                                                |
| <b>Rick Jones</b>       | Resourceful teenager; later a cosmic hero                                                                                                                                                                                    | Hides Banner, lures the Army away                                                                                                                                      | His future with Captain Marvel and the Destiny Force (Phase 2 and 3)                                                 | ✅ 100%                                                                                                                |
| <b>Samuel Sterns</b>    | Becomes the <b>Leader</b> , with a super-genius intellect and psionic powers ( <i>TtA</i> #62)                                                                                                                               | Gamma exposure in the mid-credit scene; his skull starts to swell                                                                                                      | The full Leader (a later Hulk film)                                                                                  | ✅ 100%                                                                                                                |

## 4. STORY

| Field                | Entry                                                                                                   |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Logline              | A brilliant scientist saves a boy from his own bomb and becomes the monster the Army built it to fight. |
| Theme                | <b>The monster we make of each other.</b> Banner is hunted by the man who should have protected him.    |
| Villain / antagonist | <b>Emil Blonsky / the Abomination</b> (main); <b>Gen. Thunderbolt Ross</b> (the relentless hunter)      |

### What the movie is about

#### ACT ONE: THE BOMB

- **Desert Base, New Mexico, Monday, March 3, 2008.** Dr. Bruce Banner's G-bomb is ready to test. At the countdown, a jittery teenager, **Rick Jones**, drives onto the range on a dare.
- Banner orders a hold and runs out to save him. His assistant, secretly an ex-Soviet intelligence asset, **doesn't hold the countdown**. Banner shoves Rick into a trench and takes the full blast.
- He survives without a mark. That night at sunset, **the gray Hulk** tears out of the base hospital.
- Rick sees it happen and understands what he's looking at. By sunrise the monster is Banner again.

#### ACT TWO: THE HUNT

- Ross declares the "gray thing" an enemy of the state and launches the hunt. It's the story Tony Stark's workshop TV reports in *Iron Man*.
- Banner and Rick go on the run across the Southwest while **Betty** hides them from her father.
- Midway through, the Hulk changes **from gray to green**, and the change starts coming **with anger instead of darkness**. Banner can't hide in daylight anymore.
- **Emil Blonsky**, a mercenary who has joined Ross's task force, is actually selling Banner's gamma research to the handlers who arranged the "accident."
- The Hulk wrecks Blonsky's unit at the Hoover Dam, and it's the humiliation of Blonsky's life.

#### ACT THREE: THE ABOMINATION

- Blonsky breaks into Banner's old lab and gives himself **a massive gamma dose**, becoming **the Abomination**, who is permanent and fully aware.
  - He tears through Albuquerque to draw the Hulk out.
  - **Round one:** the Abomination is stronger, and the Hulk loses.
  - **Round two:** after the Abomination nearly kills Rick and Betty, the Hulk's rage **keeps climbing past every limit**, until he's stronger than anything Blonsky can match.
  - Ross watches the Hulk save his daughter and his soldiers.
  - Banner escapes. The last image is a green giant leaping into the New Mexico night while Rick watches from a hilltop.
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## 5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

| Field                   | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it's set           | <b>Monday, March 3, 2008</b> (the G-bomb) → <b>Saturday, May 31, 2008</b> (the Albuquerque battle). The post-credit scene takes place <b>Friday, June 6, 2008</b> .                                              |
| Where it's set          | <b>Desert Base, New Mexico</b> (filmed at White Sands / Alamogordo) · the Southwestern deserts · <b>Hoover Dam, Nevada–Arizona border</b> · <b>Albuquerque, New Mexico</b>                                       |
| Relative to other films | <b>It overlaps <i>Iron Man</i></b> . The G-bomb goes off while Tony is a prisoner in Kunar, and the hunt is on the news during his Mark II build. The post-credit scene happens six weeks after "I am Iron Man." |

## 6. WORLD-BUILDING

### The film's own world

- **Desert Base**, the **G-bomb program**, the **gray, then green Hulk**, and the anger rule.
- **Rick Jones** as the Hulk's conscience, **Betty**, and **Ross**, the father who hunts the man his daughter loves.
- The gamma "**family**" **starts here**: the Abomination now, and the Leader later.

### World-building for the wider MCU

| Seed                          | How it appears                                                                                                                  | Payoff                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>S.H.I.E.L.D.</b>           | Sitwell shows up at Desert Base with a jurisdiction letter and a gamma-sample case.                                             | <i>The Avengers</i>                                                                                  |
| <b>Tony Stark</b>             | The post-credit scene (see below)                                                                                               | <i>The Avengers</i>                                                                                  |
| <b>The Leader</b>             | The mid-credit scene                                                                                                            | A future Hulk film                                                                                   |
| <b>Rick Jones</b>             | He becomes the Hulk's best friend and <b>the one who radios for help</b>                                                        | <i>The Avengers</i> , where Rick's radio call is what brings the team together ( <i>Avengers</i> #1) |
| <b>Super-soldier research</b> | Ross's hand-picked soldiers talk about an old WWII program called " <b>Project: Rebirth</b> " that nobody could ever reproduce. | <i>Captain America</i>                                                                               |

## Setting up the Big Bad

| Seed                    | How it appears                                                                                                                                                                                           | What it means                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Rick Jones</b>       | He's introduced as an ordinary kid in the wrong place                                                                                                                                                    | <b>On 616, Rick is at the center of the cosmic war</b> ( <i>Captain Marvel</i> #17 on, bonded to Mar-Vell during the Thanos War, <i>Captain Marvel</i> #25–33). The boy who started the Hulk is the boy the cosmos will call on. |
| <b>The Titan signal</b> | In the Desert Base control room, a radio telescope logs an intense <b>gamma-wave pulse from the direction of Saturn</b> in the same second the G-bomb goes off. A technician marks it "instrument echo." | Something on Titan <b>noticed the gamma bomb</b> .                                                                                                                                                                               |

## 7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

| Field                         | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Mid-credit scene</b>       | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> <b>"THE HEADACHE."</b> A chemical plant outside Albuquerque. Laborer <b>Samuel Sterns</b> is cleaning up the battle debris and <b>gets a face full of green gamma sludge</b> from a ruptured canister. He wipes it off, then winces at a sudden headache. A close-up shows <b>a vein pulsing across his skull</b> , and he smiles like he's just understood something. |
| <b>Post-credit scene</b>      | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> <b>"THE BAR."</b> A roadside bar near Desert Base. Ross drinks alone. <b>Tony Stark</b> sits down beside him.<br><b>TONY:</b> "Word is you've got a problem. Big, green, bad at listening."<br><b>ROSS:</b> "And you're here to help."<br><b>TONY:</b> "No. I'm here because somebody's putting a team together." <b>CUT TO BLACK.</b>                                 |
| <b>Secret shoot codenames</b> | Mid-credit: " <b>JANITORIAL.</b> " Post-credit: " <b>HAPPY HOUR.</b> "                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

## CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline